

Class 5: Aspects of Social Movement Activity

Collective identity and emotions

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Agenda for the day

- Opening notes
- Klausur preview follow-up
- Reviewing Week 4: Mobilisation, recruitment, participation
- Collective identity
- Cleavages - one grand theory to explain it all...
- Collective identity in action
- Any questions, concerns, feedback for this class?

Opening notes



December

January

Presentations line-up

Date	Presenters	Method
4 Dec:		TBD
11 Dec:		TBD
18 Dec:		TBD

Klausur preview follow-up

- structure of an essay
 1. Broad introductory response
 2. Elaborate in (sufficient) detail to answer the questions
 3. Describe examples
 4. Concluding summary

any follow-up questions on this?
(full review in late January)



Reviewing Week 4: Mobilisation, recruitment, participation

- Individuals in networks, summing up
- Organisations



Individuals in networks, summing up

- networks perform many (movement-related) functions
 - **socialisation**
 - influencing individuals' decisions/sympathies
 - should I stay involved? should I advocate for more radical actions? should I support different leadership?
- *weak ties* can serve as better source for **mobilisation** than *strong ties* because *weak ties are more likely to be inclusive and link to organisations/opportunities to engage* (Granovetter 1973)
 - e.g., U.S. Civil Rights Movement relied on 'weak-tie networks'; Italian *Brigate Rosse* relied on 'strong-tie networks' (i.e., family and close friends)
- networks are important, but *not necessary and not solely sufficient for mobilisation* of an individual
 - powerful combination of **strong commitment** and **strong ties to other participants** = *continued participation*
 - amenable networks and frame resonance are sufficient to mobilise individuals (without need of prior connection to an org.) (cf. della Porta and Diani 2009, 125)

any follow-up questions on this?

1. orgs emerge out of **episodes of contention**
 2. orgs begin locally and scale up/spread through contention
 3. key to org survival is **interpersonal networks** within them (cf. Ganz 2010 on organisational structure enhancing strategic capacity)
- difference between **bureaucratic organisations** and **grassroots radical organisations** – one common org. type distinction
 - **Exclusive affiliations:**
 - demand long membership accession, rigid discipline, high level of commitment
 - closed off to outside
 - *examples?*
 - **Multiple affiliations:**
 - not monopolising members' commitment
 - multiple commitments is a source of strength
 - facilitates circulation of information, especially through informal/interpersonal networks

any follow-up questions on this?

Collective identity

- defining collective identity
- visible collective identity
example 1
- discussion question
- visible collective identity
example 2
- collective identity and
participation
- intersectionality



Defining collective identity

Visible collective identity, example



Visible collective identity, example



Is collective identity a
**‘process’ or a ‘product’? (What
about in cases you know of?)**

Visible collective identity, example

anyone know what's going on here?



- pro-abortion rights movement in Argentina – an item that helps identification in the public space
 - tactic: get celebrities to hold a green scarf

- **group identification** bridges *social identity* (i.e., membership in social category) with *collective identity* (i.e., membership in a conscious collective)
 - the social psychological answer to why people participate in protest
 - *the more people identify with a group, the more inclined they are to protest on behalf of that group*

- **group identification** bridges *social identity* (i.e., membership in social category) with *collective identity* (i.e., membership in a conscious collective)
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- Key distinction:
 - *ascribed* group membership - difficult to change
 - *acquired* group membership - adopted by choice
 - examples?

Collective identity and participation

- people typically hold many different identities, simultaneously
 - i.e., many different identities overlap, interweave, ... *intersect*
- **dual identity** - one can feel impelled to protest due to some **group identification**, but also loyal to an overarching system of which they are a part
 - *healthy for protest participation in a democracy*

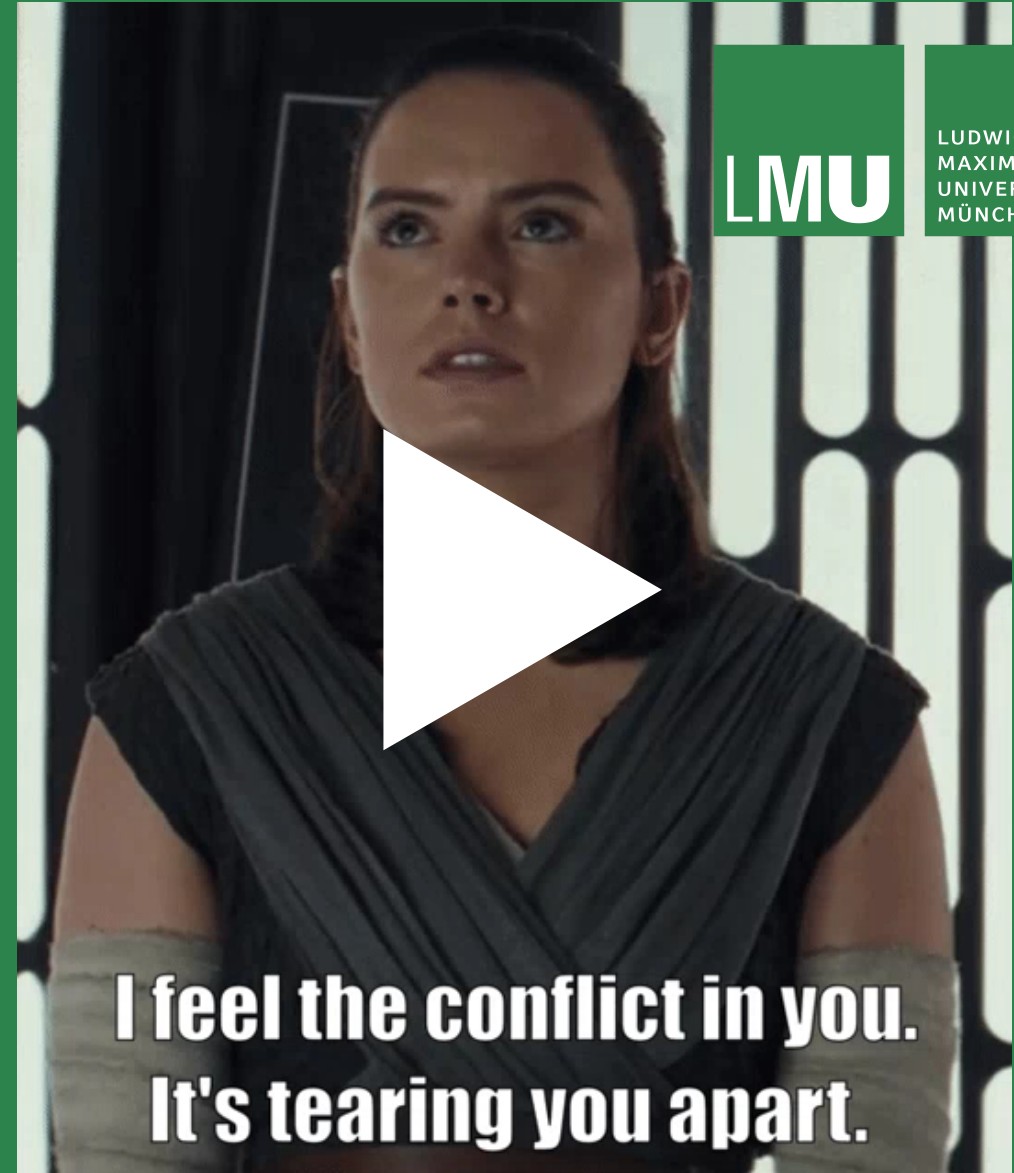
Activists may define their identities in different ways **depending on the strategic situation**. If they are representing their group to a public audience, they may cast themselves as more unified and more homogeneous than they would in a setting of fellow activists.

Cleavages - one grand theory to explain it all...

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- turning identity into action
- values and attitudes
- materialist and post-materialist values
- silent (counter-)revolution
- cleavages and collective identity



What turns identity into action?

- group-based conflict within society can stimulate group identification

What turns identity into action?

- group-based conflict within society can stimulate group identification



It's all about...

Values

Attitudes

It's all about...

Attitudes

Values

- broad, deep-seated beliefs about what is important in life
- stable over time, typically long-term and more abstract
- influenced by socialisation (e.g., family, culture, education)
- e.g., societies of survival vs. self-expression

It's all about...

Values

Attitudes

It's all about...

Values

Attitudes

- specific and short-term predispositions or opinions that individuals hold toward specific objects, issues, or policies
- situational, influenced by context (e.g., economic conditions, political events) and personal experiences

It's all about...

Values

Attitudes

values *shape* attitudes

values & attitudes in brief (Inglehart, Norris, Welzel)

- Inglehart magnifies Maslow's **hierarchy of needs** to societal (macro-) level of analysis → aligns with groups and their socio-political values and attitudes



- basic material needs satisfied enables seeking non-material needs

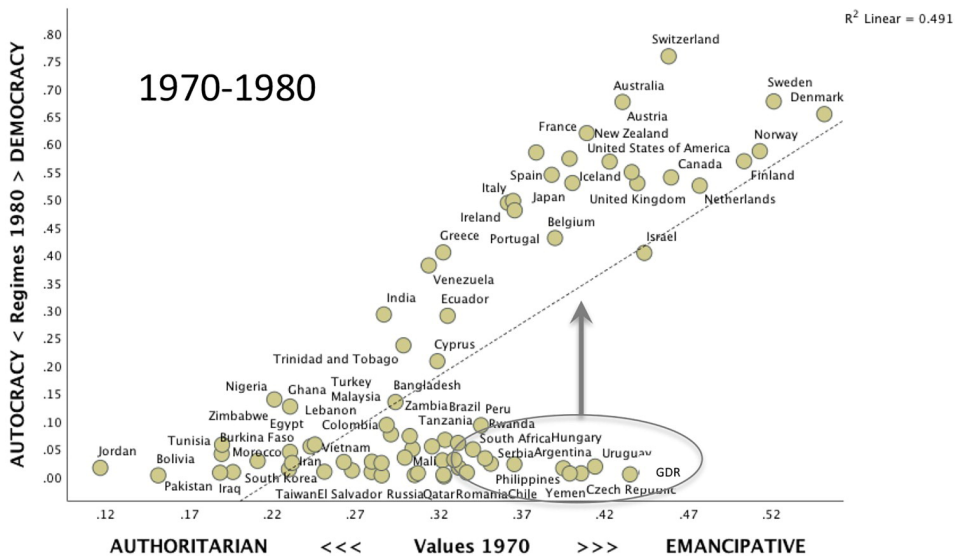
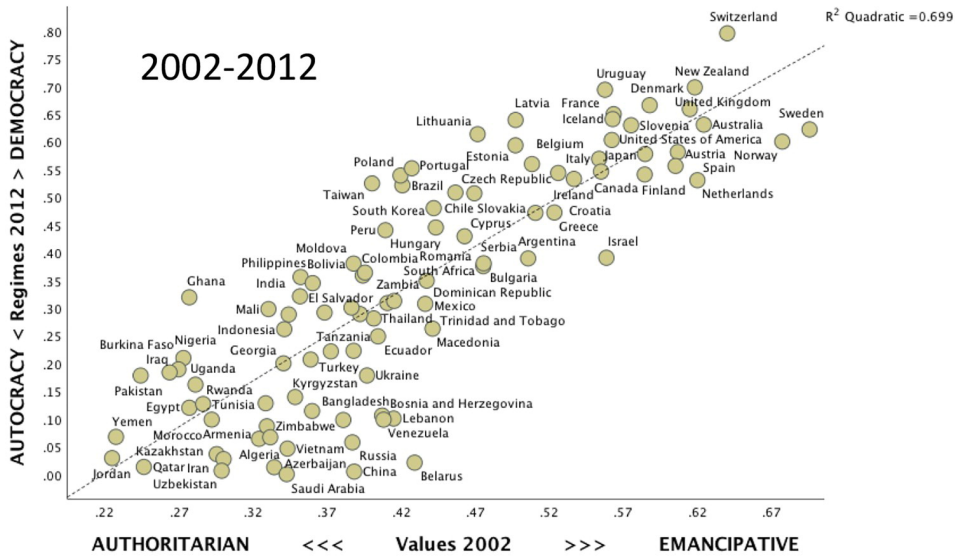
values & attitudes in brief (Inglehart, Norris, Welzel)

- **materialist values**
 - economic growth (maintaining stability and order)
 - security and material needs safeguarded
 - traditional morality
- **post-materialist values** (evidence: decline in religious values; effect: rise of green parties and new social movements)
 - freedoms, liberties, rights — autonomy and expression
 - gender and racial equality
 - environmental protection
- societal groups (existing **cleavages**) show tendencies for these values groups: generationally, regionally, class-based, religiously

values & attitudes in brief (Inglehart, Norris, Welzel)



Welzel 2021 - transformative power of values



- This matters...
 - because **cleavages** (macro-level) form common basis for **social identity** and **group identification** (micro-level), which in turn fuels **collective identity**
- Materialist - Post-materialist **cleavage**, for example, may be the root of
 - movements of ethno-nationalists opposing migration rights movements
 - climate preservation movements opposing economic development movements

Collective identity in action

- humour in social movements
- summarising collective identity



Humour in 'new atheist movement' (Guenther et al.

- 3 years of fieldwork in southern California on movement activities
- humour used to...
 - form/maintain **collective identity**, including establish **boundaries** ('we're funny; the religious are dull and dour')
 - manage stigma of being 'unbeliever'
 - **mobilise** ('come join our fun, jokey group')
 - perform actions (cf. **Bogad 2016** on 'tactical frivolity')

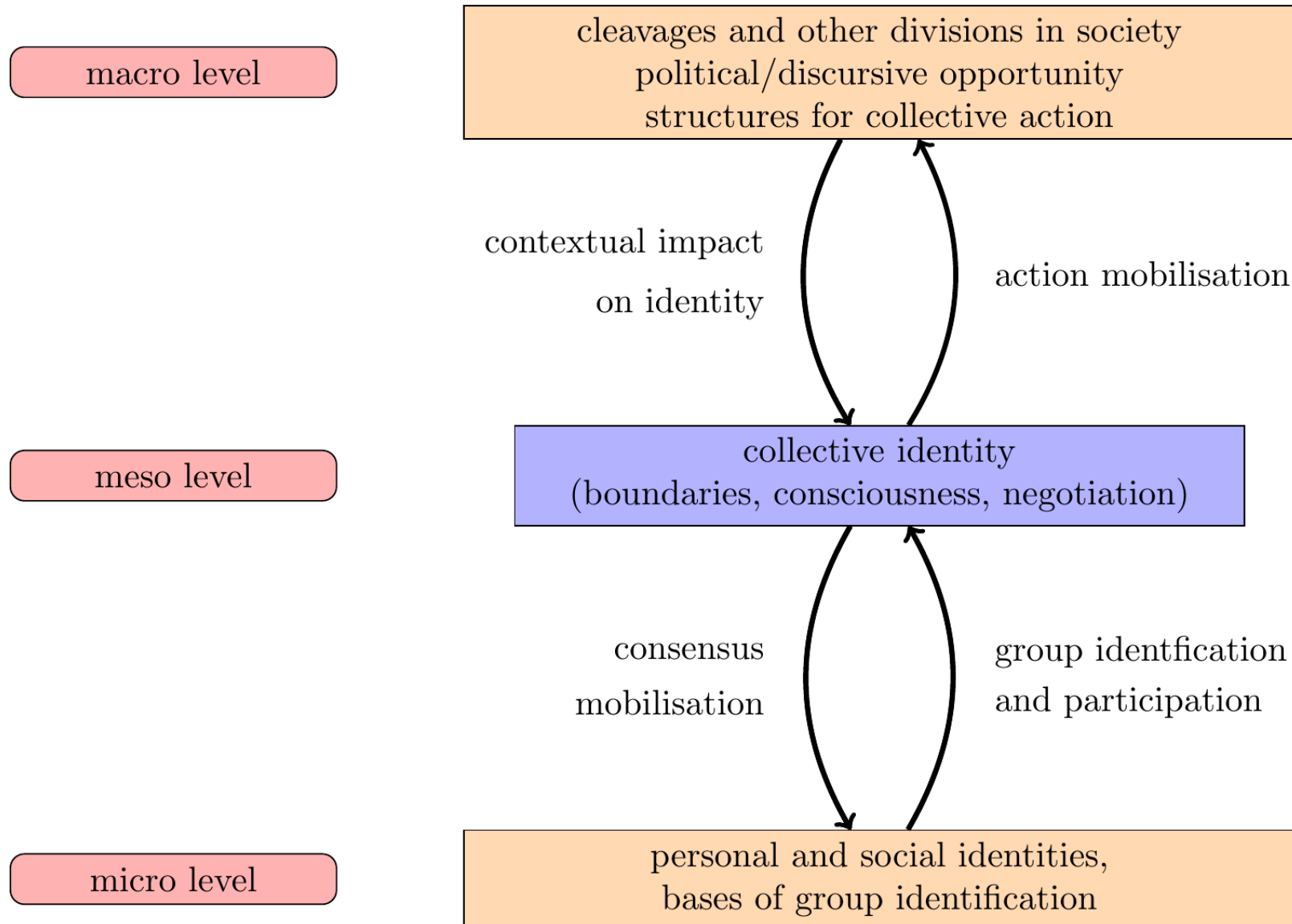


Humour in 'new atheist movement' (Guenther et al.

- 3 years of fieldwork in southern California on movement activities
- humour as **collective identity**
 - reflected in framing: e.g., opponents represented as ridiculous
 - tactics: humour as less confrontational mode of opposition (cf. Bogad 2016)



Collective identity, summary notes



Collective identity, summary notes

collective identity is...

- both an individual-level and group-level phenomenon
- composed of **boundaries**, **consciousness**, and **negotiation**
- *fluid, adaptable, and relational* – not fixed
- a result and part of continually developing **intersecting identities**
- not same as ‘ideological commitment’
 - one can join a movement for ideological reasons without identifying with members, and vice versa

Any questions, concerns, feedback for this class?

Anonymous feedback here: <https://forms.gle/AjHt6fcnwZxkSg4X8>

Alternatively, please send me an email: m.zeller@lmu.de

References

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- della Porta, Donatella, and Mario Diani. 2009. *Social Movements: An Introduction*. Oxford: Oxford University Press. <https://doi.org/10.1016/B978-008044910-4.00803-8>.
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